Measuring blood pressure

Word bank

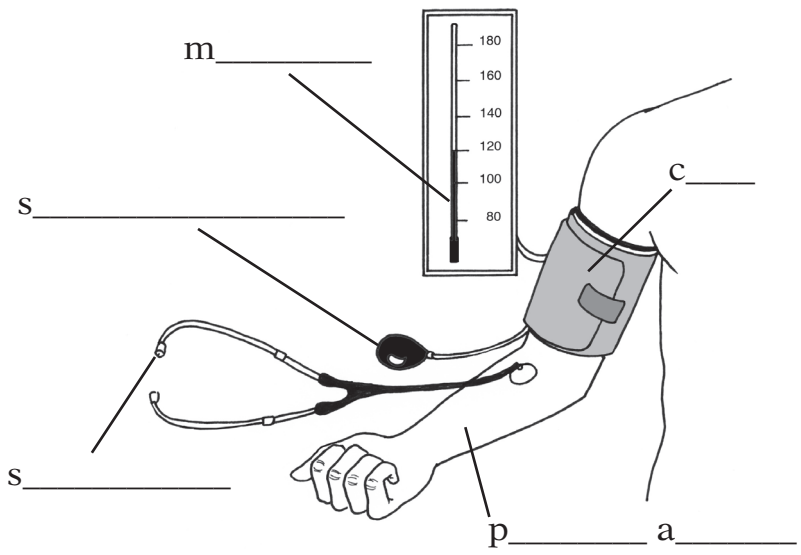
pressure
diastolic
body
maximum
heart
artery
two
sphygmomanometer
level
listens
mercury
stethoscope
pumped

☞ **1** Use the word bank to complete the passage below.

Measuring blood pressure tells doctors a lot about a patient's h_____ and the condition of their blood vessels. Traditionally t____ important pieces of technology were always used for measuring blood pressure – the **stethoscope** and the **sphygmomanometer**.

The s_____ has a cuff, two air tubes and a reservoir of m_____ in a vertical glass column. When air is p_____ into the cuff, the pressure is shown by the mercury l_____ in the column. The doctor puts the s_____ to the patient's arm and l_____ to their pulse. The **systolic** pressure is when the doctor first hears the pulse. It is the m_____ pressure in an a_____ when the heart beats, pumping blood through the b_____. The d_____ pressure is when the doctor can't hear the pulse any more. This is the lowest p_____ in an artery. Nowadays blood pressure is monitored electronically using a cuff and a special machine, but the traditional method works just as well.

2 Use the word bank to label the picture below.



Word bank

mercury
cuff
stethoscope
sphygmomanometer
patient's arm

3 Decide whether these statements are true or false.

The stethoscope has a cuff attached to it. _____

The cuff pressure is shown on the mercury column. _____

Diastolic pressure is measured when no pulse can be heard. _____

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